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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 1 : Session – 9 | Analysing Desires, Thoughts and Expectations

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. Three categorisations of desires/thoughts/expectations: (1) By SOURCE of motivation — arising from PRECONDITIONING, from SENSATION, or from NATURAL ACCEPTANCE. (2) By NATURE of the need — needs of the SELF (happiness, respect, understanding) versus needs of the BODY (food, shelter). (3) By TIME — CONTINUOUS (always wanted, e.g., respect) versus TEMPORARY (occasional, e.g., eating). These three lenses together reveal what the desire really is and whether it can be fulfilled materially.
2. Q2. Need of the Self (I): happiness, respect, trust, knowledge — CONTINUOUS in time, QUALITATIVE (not measurable in quantity), fulfilled by RIGHT UNDERSTANDING and RIGHT FEELING. Need of the Body: food, clothing, shelter — TEMPORARY in time, QUANTITATIVE (limited — one can eat only so much), fulfilled by PHYSICAL FACILITY. CONCLUSION of the exercise: most of our significant desires are needs of the Self, yet most of our effort and resources go into physical facility for the body — a fundamental misplacement of effort that explains why prosperity without happiness is common.
3. Q3. PRECONDITIONING: motivation from assumptions absorbed from society/upbringing without verification ('more money = more respect') — makes conduct INDEFINITE and leads to ENSLAVEMENT by prevailing trends. SENSATION: motivation from bodily tastes and excitements — temporary, addictive, also leads to ENSLAVEMENT (of the body/senses). NATURAL ACCEPTANCE: motivation from the Self's own verified inner acceptance — constant, self-evident, leads to SELF-ORGANISATION (swatantrata) and definite conduct. Only the third makes a person self-organised; the first two make one partantra (dependent/enslaved).